

Virtual Agent Topic Design & Conversation Flow Configuration

Overview

After enabling the **ITSM Virtual Agent** plugin, the next step is to design a conversational topic that supports SLA governance. The topic **SLA Breach Awareness & Justification** provides users with proactive guidance whenever an Incident approaches or exceeds its Service Level Agreement (SLA).

The Virtual Agent does not replace the Incident form; instead, it educates users about the SLA risk, explains the governance requirements, and reminds them to update the mandatory SLA fields. A decision-based conversation flow captures the user's acknowledgement and reinforces organizational compliance.

This conversational approach improves user engagement, reduces confusion, and ensures consistent SLA governance without requiring custom scripting.

Objective

The objectives of this configuration are to:

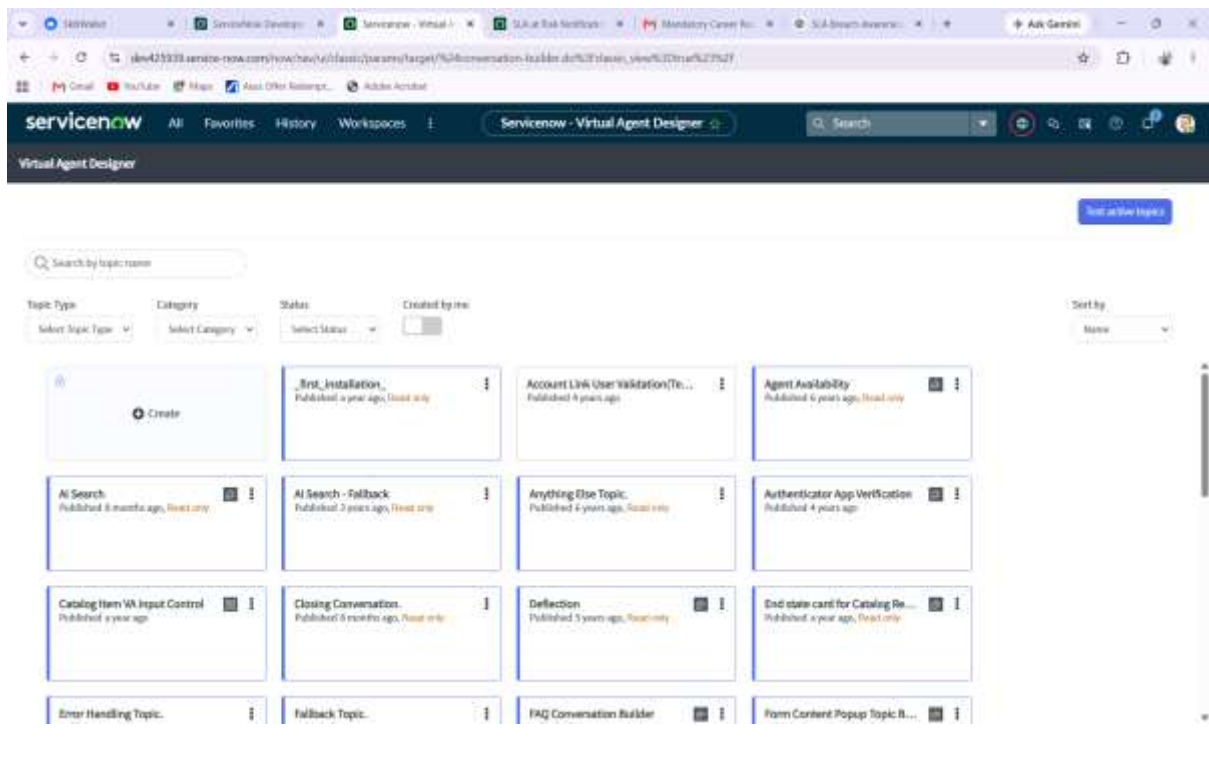
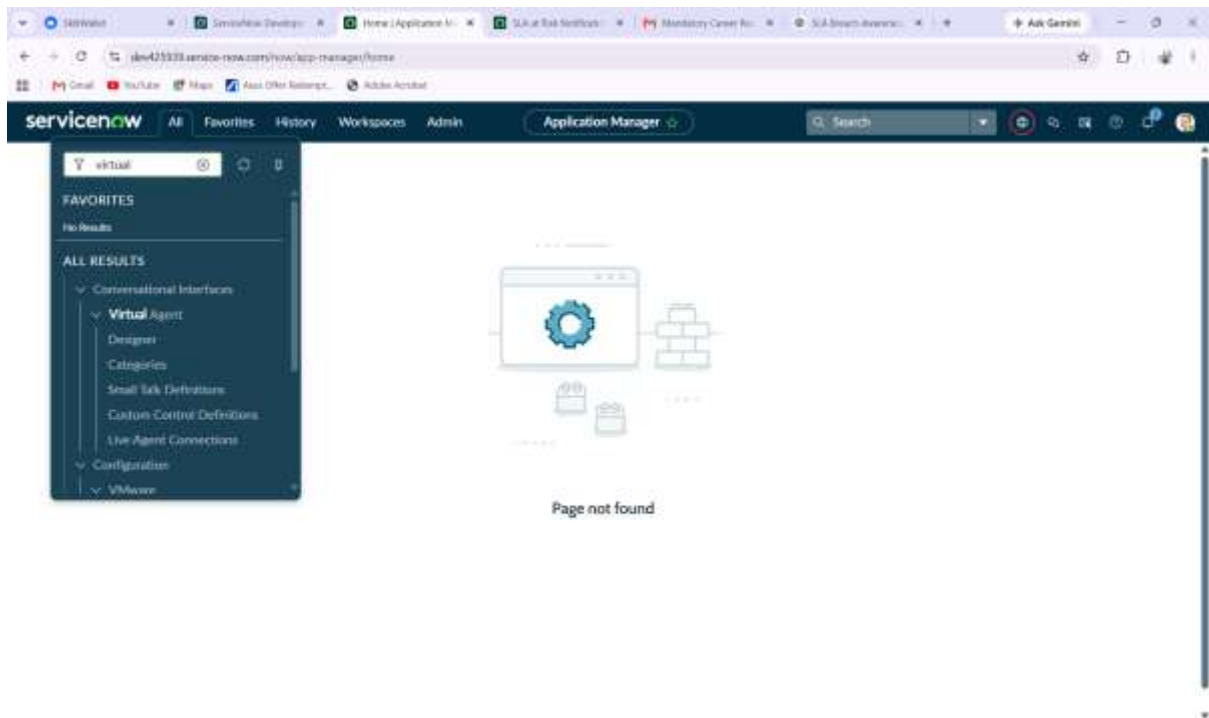
- Create a dedicated Virtual Agent topic for SLA governance.
 - Restrict access to ITIL users.
 - Provide conversational SLA awareness.
 - Guide users through the required corrective actions.
 - Capture SLA acknowledgement.
 - Improve compliance with organizational SLA policies.
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Navigation

Navigate to:

Virtual Agent → Designer

Click **Create New**.



Step 1: Create a New Topic

Configure the topic with the following information.

Field	Value
Application Scope	Global (Automatic)
Type	Topic – Internal
Topic Name	sla_breach_awareness_justification (<i>Internal name – not visible to users</i>)
Display Name	SLA Breach Awareness & Justification
Visibility	Contextual (Record-Based)
System Role	itil

Click **Save**.

Topic Configuration Summary

Property	Value
Internal Name	sla_breach_awareness_justification
Display Name	SLA Breach Awareness & Justification
Topic Type	Internal
Scope	Global
Visibility	Contextual
Required Role	itil

Conversation Flow Design

The conversation is designed using Bot Response and Decision nodes.

The overall flow is:

Greeting → SLA Guidance → Decision → Success/Reminder Response

Step 2: Greeting Message

Drag a **Text Response** node onto the canvas.

Node Name

Greeting

Response Message

⚠ This incident is approaching or has breached its Service Level Agreement (SLA).
Let's capture the required reason and justification to maintain SLA governance.

This message informs the user that immediate action is required.

Step 3: SLA Governance Guidance

Drag another **Bot Response** node below the Greeting node.

Node Name

SLA Breach Response

Response Message

To comply with SLA governance, please complete the following actions:

- Open the Incident form.
- Provide the **SLA Breach Reason**.
- Enter the **SLA Breach Justification**.
- Acknowledge the SLA risk.

These fields are mandatory before saving or updating the Incident.

This response clearly explains the actions expected from the user.

Step 4: Decision Node

Drag a **Decision** node from the **Utilities** section.

The decision checks whether the user acknowledges the SLA warning.

Example decision:

Has the user acknowledged the SLA risk?

- **Yes** → Continue to Success Response.
 - **No** → Display Reminder Response.
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Step 5: Decision – True Path

If the user selects **Yes**, connect the Decision node to a **Text Response** node.

Node Name

Acknowledgement Confirmed

Response Message

✅ Thank you for acknowledging the SLA risk.

Please return to the Incident record and complete the **SLA Breach Reason** and **SLA Breach Justification** fields before updating or resolving the Incident.

Your acknowledgement supports SLA governance and compliance.

Step 6: Decision – False Path

If the user selects **No**, connect the Decision node to another **Text Response** node.

Node Name

Acknowledgement Reminder

Response Message

⚠️ SLA acknowledgement is required as part of the organization's governance process.

Please acknowledge the SLA risk and complete the required breach information on the Incident form.

This helps maintain accurate documentation and ensures compliance with SLA governance policies.

Conversation Flow

Start

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Greeting

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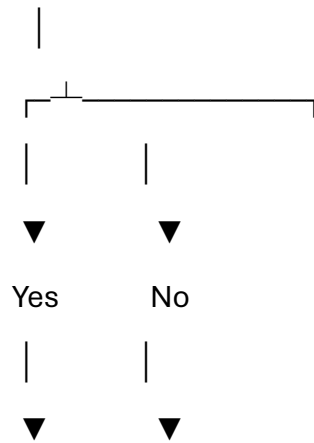
SLA Breach Response

|



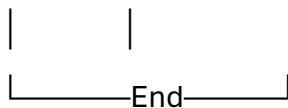
Decision

(User acknowledges SLA?)



Acknowledgement Reminder

Confirmed Response



Validation

After completing the topic configuration, verify that:

- The topic is saved successfully.
- Only users with the **itil** role can access the topic.
- The topic appears in the Virtual Agent.
- The greeting message displays correctly.
- SLA guidance is presented to the user.
- The decision node routes the conversation correctly.
- Both **True** and **False** responses display as expected.

Expected Outcome

After configuration:

- ITIL users can access the **SLA Breach Awareness & Justification** topic.

- Users receive clear guidance when an Incident approaches SLA breach.
 - The Virtual Agent reinforces governance requirements.
 - Users are reminded to update mandatory SLA fields.
 - SLA acknowledgement is encouraged through an interactive conversation.
 - User experience and SLA compliance are significantly improved.
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Benefits

- Interactive SLA awareness.
 - Improved user engagement.
 - Standardized governance communication.
 - Better accountability.
 - Reduced manual follow-up by administrators.
 - Consistent user guidance.
 - Native ServiceNow implementation without custom scripting.
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Conclusion

The **SLA Breach Awareness & Justification** Virtual Agent topic provides a conversational layer to the **Virtual Agent–Driven SLA Breach Awareness & Justification System**. Through structured greeting messages, guidance, and decision-based responses, the Virtual Agent educates users about SLA risks and encourages compliance with governance requirements. This interactive approach enhances the user experience while supporting proactive SLA management, accountability, and audit-ready documentation within the ServiceNow platform.